

HOUSE BILL No. 1203

DIGEST OF INTRODUCED BILL

Citations Affected: IC 15-20-5; IC 34-30-2.1-195.2.

Synopsis: Adoption of research animals. Requires research facilities to offer for adoption dogs or cats no longer required for research purposes.

Effective: July 1, 2026.

Hall, Baird, Miller K

January 5, 2026, read first time and referred to Committee on Agriculture and Rural Development.



Second Regular Session of the 124th General Assembly (2026)

PRINTING CODE. Amendments: Whenever an existing statute (or a section of the Indiana Constitution) is being amended, the text of the existing provision will appear in this style type, additions will appear in **this style type**, and deletions will appear in ~~this style type~~.

Additions: Whenever a new statutory provision is being enacted (or a new constitutional provision adopted), the text of the new provision will appear in **this style type**. Also, the word **NEW** will appear in that style type in the introductory clause of each SECTION that adds a new provision to the Indiana Code or the Indiana Constitution.

Conflict reconciliation: Text in a statute in *this style type* or ~~this style type~~ reconciles conflicts between statutes enacted by the 2025 Regular Session of the General Assembly.

HOUSE BILL No. 1203

A BILL FOR AN ACT to amend the Indiana Code concerning agriculture and animals.

Be it enacted by the General Assembly of the State of Indiana:

1 SECTION 1. IC 15-20-5 IS ADDED TO THE INDIANA CODE AS
2 A **NEW** CHAPTER TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE JULY
3 1, 2026]:

4 **Chapter 5. Retired Animal Adoption**

5 **Sec. 1. As used in this chapter, "animal care facility" has the**
6 **meaning set forth in IC 6-9-39-1.**

7 **Sec. 2. (a) As used in this chapter, "research facility" means a**
8 **privately or government owned, leased, or operated:**

9 (1) **partnership;**

10 (2) **corporation;**

11 (3) **association;**

12 (4) **school;**

13 (5) **institution; or**

14 (6) **organization;**

15 **located in Indiana that uses animals for experimentation or**
16 **research or that tests chemical substances, ingredients, drugs,**
17 **medical devices, vaccines, products, or product formulations on**



1 animals.

2 (b) The term includes a facility that carries out biomedical
3 research or educational research.

4 (c) The term does not include:

- 5 (1) a partnership;
- 6 (2) a corporation;
- 7 (3) an association;
- 8 (4) a school;
- 9 (5) an institution; or
- 10 (6) an organization;

11 that primarily provides veterinary services to an animal.

12 Sec. 3. As used in this chapter, "retired animal" means a dog or
13 cat that:

- 14 (1) is confined at a research facility;
- 15 (2) has previously been used for research;
- 16 (3) is no longer required for research purposes; and
- 17 (4) the research facility's attending veterinarian deems
18 suitable for adoption.

19 Sec. 4. A research facility shall establish an adoption program
20 for retired animals confined at the research facility.

21 Sec. 5. A research facility shall offer a retired animal for
22 adoption to:

- 23 (1) an animal care facility; or
- 24 (2) an individual for private placement in the individual's
25 permanent home;

26 unless euthanizing the retired animal is required for health, safety,
27 or research reasons.

28 Sec. 6. A research facility may enter into a collaborative
29 agreement with one (1) or more animal care facilities for the
30 purpose of carrying out the provisions of section 5 of this chapter.

31 Sec. 7. Once a retired animal is eligible for adoption, the
32 research facility shall do one (1) of the following:

- 33 (1) Offer to transfer ownership and custody of the retired
34 animal to an animal care facility to facilitate the transfer of
35 ownership and custody of the retired animal to an individual
36 for placement into the individual's permanent home.
- 37 (2) Offer to transfer ownership and custody of the retired
38 animal to an individual for private placement in the
39 individual's permanent home according to an arrangement
40 agreed to by the research facility and the individual adopting
41 the retired animal.

42 Sec. 8. A research facility that acts in good faith to transfer a



1 **retired animal under section 7 of this chapter is immune from civil**
2 **liability for acts or circumstances related to or resulting from the**
3 **transfer of the retired animal.**

4 SECTION 2. IC 34-30-2.1-195.2 IS ADDED TO THE INDIANA
5 CODE AS A NEW SECTION TO READ AS FOLLOWS
6 [EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: **Sec. 195.2. IC 15-20-5-8 (Concerning**
7 **a research facility providing a retired animal to an animal care**
8 **facility or individual for adoption).**

